Computer assisted discovery and open coding

Digital Methods

Julie Hvidsteen

6th of May 2025

UNIVERSITY OF COPENHAGEN

Agenda

- Check-in Slides
- General feedback for milestone 2

45 min

- Individual group feedback (Open coding)

45 min

- Work on your project

45 min

To do list

TUESDAY

1) Work on open coding of own data.
2) Data collection continued
3) Set up code for computer assisted discovery
4) Continue with open coding and exploratory text analysis

General feedback for Milestone 2

Excellent job so far

- Be explicit about which design you're using (exploratory sequential, explanatory sequential, convergent, etc.)
  - Ensure all parts of your project consistently reflect this choice!
- Justify why your sample is appropriate
  - What does it allow you to do?
- Think of triangulation
  - How might your qualitative and quantitative components validate and complement each other? Approach your research question from multiple angles to cross-verify findings.

Coding the data – What does it mean?

What is coding in qualitative research?

- Coding is a key analytical process in qualitative research
- It involves labeling and categorizing data to identify patterns, themes, or concepts (topics, people, actions etc.)

What is Open Coding?

Open coding is the first step in qualitative analysis. It involves breaking down qualitative data (e.g., text, videos, interview transcripts, open-ended survey responses) into discrete parts and assigning labels (codes) that capture their meaning.

- This process helps to organize raw data without imposing pre-existing frameworks
- The goal isn't to quantify but to understand patterns and meanings across the data

Why is coding important?

- Helps reveal key themes and insights
- Moves you from raw observation to structured analysis
- Supports the development of theory – interesting theoretical perspectives
- Refines the focus of your project and guides next steps

From computer lead to computer assisted text analysis

Research phases:

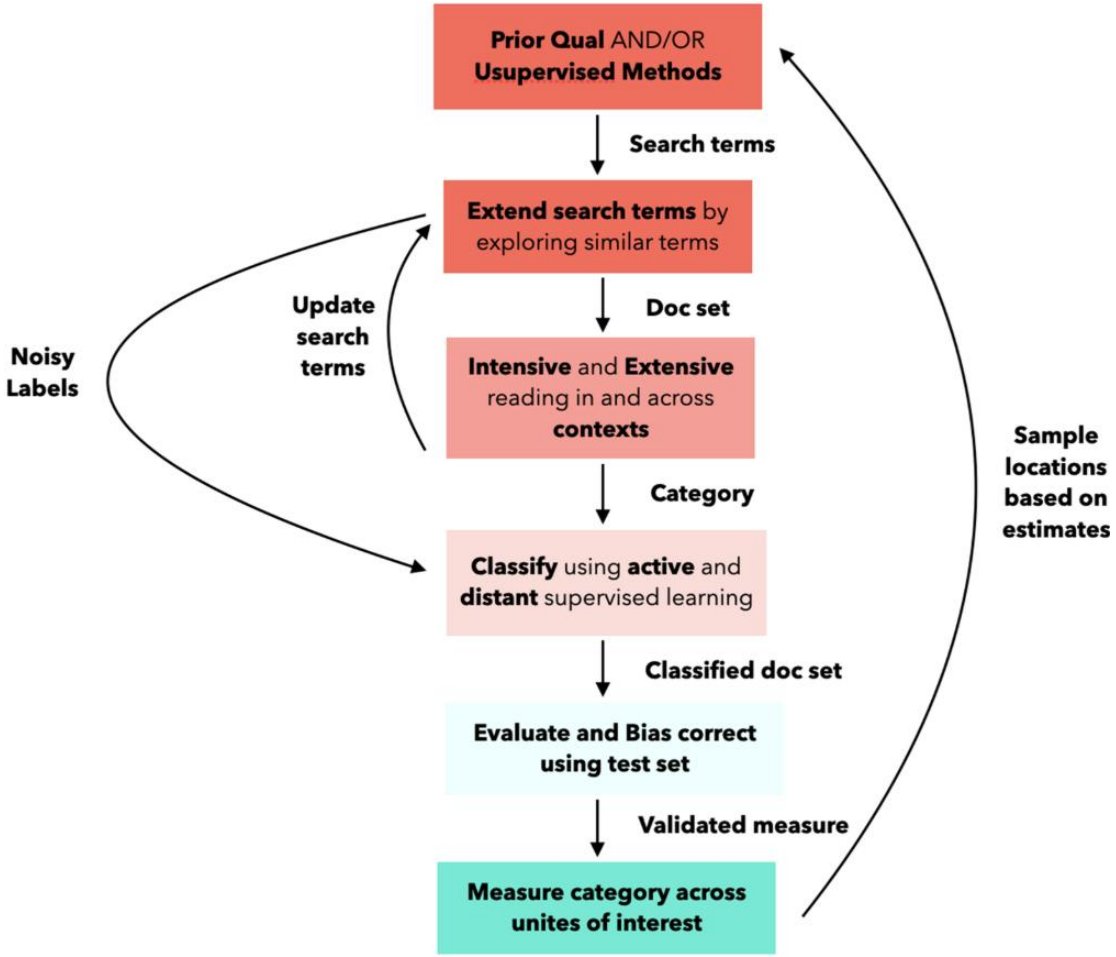
Discovery - Using computational methods to identify patterns

Grounding - Interpreting and contextualizing the patterns

Classification - Systematically organizing findings

Evaluation - Testing validity of findings

Measurement - Quantifying patterns for further analysis



Milestone 3

- **Milestone 3** – Friday, 16th of May, 23:59, via email to TA (hsl448@sodas.ku.dk)
- Feedback – next seminar
- Submission should contain:
  1. Data Collection Update
  2. Data Analysis Design Update
  3. Initial analysis(mainly qualitative)

  Remember to book your supervision slot for Thursday – seminar hours are held as usual.
- Max. 2 pages